

# BEETLEFOLK

**B**EETLEFOLK IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS AN INSECTOID CIVILIZATION BUILT AROUND COLONY structure, hardened chitin, and disciplined defensive behavior. Rather than acting as chaotic monsters, beetlefolk operate with instinctive cooperation and caste-like roles that shape how they fight, build, and defend their tunnels.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and encounter variety without CR inflation. This ladder progresses from vulnerable larval young through increasingly specialized battlefield castes, culminating in the Scarab Sage who directs the colony through ritual magic and pheromone command. The ladder caps at CR 6 so that beetlefolk remain regional threats suited for settlements, tunnel systems, and wilderness colonies rather than world-ending forces.

Beetlefolk encounters emphasize formation fighting, terrain familiarity, and biological specialization. Some castes dig, some hold defensive lines, and others break enemy ranks through sheer momentum. When used together they create encounters that feel coordinated and instinctively organized rather than chaotic.

Cultural details are intentionally minimal. Whether beetlefolk are an ancient subterranean civilization, a magically altered species, or simply an unusual insectoid people is left to the GM. These stat blocks are tools for building colonies, tunnel defenses, and strange frontier encounters wherever they best fit your world.

## BEETLEFOLK ROSTER

| Name                   | Challenge Rating | Description                                                                                   |
|------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Beetlefolk Larva       | 0                | Soft-bodied young protected deep within colony chambers until their chitin hardens.           |
| Beetlefolk Drone       | 1/4              | Broad-backed laborer and basic defender forming the colony's frontline workers.               |
| Beetlefolk Burrower    | 1/2              | Digging skirmisher capable of ambushing enemies from below the earth.                         |
| Beetlefolk Shellguard  | 2                | Heavy infantry with layered chitin armor that anchors defensive lines.                        |
| Beetlefolk Hornstriker | 4                | Shock warrior built around brutal horn charges that break enemy formations.                   |
| Beetlefolk Scarab Sage | 6                | Mystic colony leader who guides beetlefolk through ritual earth magic and command pheromones. |



## BEETLEFOLK BURROWER

Medium humanoid (beetlefolk), neutral

**Armor Class** 15 (chitin armor)

**Hit Points** 45 (6d8 + 18)

**Speed** 30 ft., burrow 20 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT    | WIS     | CHA    |
|---------|---------|---------|--------|---------|--------|
| 15 (+2) | 12 (+1) | 16 (+3) | 8 (-1) | 11 (+0) | 8 (-1) |

**Skills** Stealth +3

**Senses** darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 10

**Languages** Beetlefolk, Common

**Challenge** 1/2 (100 XP)

**Tunnel Fighter.** This beetlefolk does not suffer disadvantage on attack rolls while prone or while squeezing through tight spaces.

**Earthsense.** While touching the ground, this beetlefolk knows the location of any creature moving on the same surface within its tremorsense.

### ACTIONS

**Claw.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

**Sudden Emergence (Recharge 5–6).** If this beetlefolk begins its turn underground, it can burst from the ground into an unoccupied space within 5 feet of a creature it can sense. That creature must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage and fall prone.

- This beetlefolk ambushes intruders from below, striking suddenly from tunnels.
- It prefers to attack isolated creatures or those standing still on loose soil.
- Burrowers often undermine defensive positions or collapse tunnel walls during fights.



## BEETLEFOLK SHELLGUARD

Medium humanoid (beetlefolk), neutral

**Armor Class** 18 (heavy chitin, shield)

**Hit Points** 85 (10d8 + 40)

**Speed** 30 ft.

| STR     | DEX     | CON     | INT    | WIS     | CHA     |
|---------|---------|---------|--------|---------|---------|
| 18 (+4) | 10 (+0) | 18 (+4) | 9 (-1) | 12 (+1) | 10 (+0) |

**Saving Throws** Con +6

**Senses** darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

**Languages** Beetlefolk, Common

**Challenge** 2 (450 XP)

**Living Bulwark.** Allied beetlefolk within 5 feet of this beetlefolk gain a +1 bonus to AC.

**Heavy Carapace.** When this beetlefolk is subjected to an effect that would push or knock it prone, it has advantage on the saving throw to resist the effect.

### ACTIONS

**Shellguard Spear.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage.

**Shield Bash.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be pushed 5 feet.

- Shellguards form the defensive core of beetlefolk tunnel defenses.
- This beetlefolk plants its shield and holds position rather than chasing enemies.
- Groups of shellguards often block narrow tunnels or chamber entrances.



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